

Replication Package README

The Foreign Policy Impact of Trade-Based Status Gains: When China Overtakes the US as Top Trade Partner

Manoel Galdino

2026-02-13

Contents

1	Q&A (Quick Answers)	1
2	1. Scope and Citation	2
3	2. Package Contents	2
4	3. Data Sources and Access	3
5	4. Computational Requirements	3
6	5. Reproduction Steps	3
6.1	5.1 Open project	3
6.2	5.2 Restore packages	3
6.3	5.3 Prepare raw data	3
6.4	5.4 Run full pipeline	3
6.5	5.5 Render manuscript	4
7	6. Validation Scripts	4
8	7. Expected Outputs	4
9	8. Notes on Reproducibility	4
10	9. Contact	4

1 Q&A (Quick Answers)

Q1. What does this package replicate?

It reproduces the analyses and manuscript for `paper_v3.pdf`, including the Brazilian SDiD design and the cross-country staggered DiD analyses.

Q2. What is the main manuscript source file?

`paper_v3.Rmd` is the current main paper source in this replication package.

Q3. Is all raw data bundled here?

No. Raw inputs must be downloaded from Dataverse and unzipped into `raw data/` before running the full pipeline.

Q4. What should I run first?

Restore the R environment with `renv::restore()`, then run `targets::tar_make()`, then render `paper_v3.Rmd`.

Q5. Is internet access required for the default replication path?

No. The package includes local cache files in `raw data/` and precomputed NLP classifications in `chatgpt data/`, so the default run does not require API calls or scraping.

2 1. Scope and Citation

This package accompanies the manuscript:

The Foreign Policy Impact of Trade-Based Status Gains: When China Overtakes the US as Top Trade Partner

If you use this package, cite the manuscript version submitted with this replication archive and cite original data providers listed below.

3 2. Package Contents

Path	Purpose
<code>_targets.R</code>	Main pipeline definition (data processing, estimation, diagnostics, plots).
<code>scripts/functions.R</code>	Core project functions used by <code>_targets.R</code> .
<code>paper_v3.Rmd</code>	Main manuscript source file.
<code>paper_v3.pdf</code>	Compiled manuscript included in the package.
<code>paper_status_trade_submission.Rmd</code>	Alternative manuscript file used in submission workflow.
<code>chatgpt data/</code>	Precomputed headline classifications used by paper sections on media salience.
<code>data/heterogeneity_vars.rds</code>	Precomputed heterogeneity variables used by cross-country extensions.
<code>data/folha_validation_sample_annotated.csv</code>	Manual-vs-LLM validation sample used in Appendix (<code>chatgpt-validation</code> chunk).
<code>images/table1_headlines.png</code>	Static image used in Appendix sample table figure.
<code>raw data/folha_scrape_cache.rds</code>	Local cache replacing mandatory online Folha scraping in default replication.
<code>raw data/wb_data_cache.rds</code>	Local cache replacing mandatory online World Bank API call in default replication.
<code>raw data/</code>	Location where Dataverse raw files must be extracted before full replication.
<code>renv.lock</code>	Locked package versions for reproducible R environment restoration.

4 3. Data Sources and Access

All core sources are public-use data. Access date for this package documentation: **2026-02-13**.

Source	Access	Notes
Harvard Dataverse replication bundle	https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/M97OCJ	Download and extract into raw data/ .
UNGA ideal points (Bailey et al.)	Included via Dataverse bundle	Used for political-alignment outcome.
International Trade and Production Database	Included via Dataverse bundle	Used for treatment timing and trade covariates.
Global Power Index and other macro covariates	Included via Dataverse bundle	Used for controls and robustness checks.
Folha de S.Paulo headlines	Derived data + local cache included	Raw outlet content is not redistributed as full-text corpus.
World Bank indicators (WDI)	Local cache included (raw data/wb_data_cache.rds)	Online fetch is optional and only needed to refresh cache.

5 4. Computational Requirements

- R $\geq$ 4.4.2
- **renv** for environment restoration
- System tools required by some packages (typical C/C++ build chain)

Suggested baseline hardware for full rebuild: modern laptop/desktop with at least 16 GB RAM.

6 5. Reproduction Steps

6.1 5.1 Open project

Open `red_trade.Rproj` in this `replication package/` directory.

6.2 5.2 Restore packages

```
install.packages("renv")
renv::restore(prompt = FALSE)
```

6.3 5.3 Prepare raw data

1. Download the Dataverse bundle from <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/M97OCJ>.
2. Unzip all files into `raw data/`, preserving folder structure.

6.4 5.4 Run full pipeline

```
library(targets)
tar_make()
```

6.5 5.5 Render manuscript

```
rmarkdown::render("paper_v3.Rmd", output_format = "pdf_document")
```

Optional submission variant:

```
rmarkdown::render("paper_status_trade_submission.Rmd", output_format = "pdf_document")
```

7 6. Validation Scripts

After building targets, optional checks can be run with:

```
source("scripts/01_load_targets_here.R")
source("scripts/02_run_did_two_covariates_here.R")
source("scripts/test_did_two_covariates_here.R")
source("scripts/test_did_covariates_outside_targets.R")
```

These scripts generate additional verification outputs under `quality_reports/`.

8 7. Expected Outputs

Main generated artifacts include:

- `_targets/` object store
- Updated manuscript PDF from `paper_v3.Rmd`
- Supplementary diagnostics from test scripts in `quality_reports/`

9 8. Notes on Reproducibility

- The package is organized to maximize deterministic replication of the reported estimates.
- Local caches in `raw data/` are used by default to avoid mandatory online calls.
- Precomputed NLP classification files are included to avoid API-related variability and costs.
- If you intentionally refresh web data, results may change relative to the archived replication state.

10 9. Contact

For replication questions, contact: **mgaldino@usp.br**